

Engineering Team Password Management Procedure

Overview

This procedure describes how the Engineering team creates, protects, and manages account passwords for systems and services we operate. It applies to all engineers, contractors, and on-call staff who hold an account on any team-owned system, repository, or cloud console.

Procedure

Creating a password

All new account passwords must be created following the company's Password Construction Guidelines (minimum length, complexity, and disallowed patterns). Every engineer must use a separate, unique password for each work-related account they hold; a password used for a work account must never also be used for a personal account.

Accounts that carry elevated or administrative privileges, such as sudo access on production hosts or admin roles in cloud consoles, must use a password that is unique from the password on that person's standard account. Multi-factor authentication is strongly recommended for these elevated accounts and is enabled by default for all cloud console admin roles.

Changing a password

We do not require engineers to rotate passwords on a fixed schedule. A password should only be changed when there is a specific reason to believe it may have been compromised — for example, after a suspected phishing attempt, a leaked-credential alert, or a lost device. When a change is required, the new password must also conform to the Password Construction Guidelines.

Protecting a password

Passwords must never be shared with anyone, including a manager, teammate, or on-call partner. All passwords are treated as confidential information. Passwords must never be put into an email, a support ticket, a chat message, or spoken over the phone to anyone, including IT support staff helping with a login issue. Passwords may only be stored in the company's approved password manager; engineers must not use a web browser's built-in "remember this password" feature on any work device.

If an engineer suspects that a password has been compromised, they must report it to the security channel immediately and change every password that may share the exposure.

Multi-factor authentication

Multi-factor authentication is encouraged for all accounts wherever the underlying system supports it, not only for work accounts but for personal accounts too.

Building authentication into our own tools

Any internal tool or service our team builds that requires a login must authenticate individual users rather than a shared group account, so that one person's access can be traced and revoked without affecting anyone else. Our tools must never store a password in plain text or in any

other easily reversible form, and must never transmit a password unencrypted over the network. Where a tool needs to let one person cover another's duties, it must do so through role or permission assignment, not by having one person learn another's password.